Gaza Peace Deadlock

GS II

- Israel and Hamas disagree over the basic conditions for peace. Israel wants Hamas to give up its weapons before reconstruction moves forward, while Hamas wants Israeli forces to withdraw before disarming. This disagreement keeps the **peace process** stuck.

- Gaza also needs **massive reconstruction** after years of destruction, displacement and shortages. But rebuilding cannot move forward easily while fighting continues and the two sides disagree over security and control of the territory.

- The conflict has also become connected with wider tensions in West Asia, including confrontation involving Iran, Lebanon and Syria. These **regional conflicts** make the Gaza issue harder to isolate and resolve through negotiations alone.

- Politics in Israel and the role of the United States also influence what happens next. Changes in public opinion, political leadership and **American pressure** can affect whether the conflict continues militarily or moves towards a negotiated settlement.

Peace in Gaza requires more than stopping the fighting. Disarmament, withdrawal, reconstruction, regional tensions and political decisions must all be addressed for a lasting settlement.